# Are Mom's Finances Organized if She Ever Needs Care?

Thirteen quick questions about what your family knows and can find. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure, from wherever you're sitting. This checks how complete your family's picture is. It doesn't measure Mom's finances, and nothing here says anything about whether she would qualify for any program.

**1.** Have you and Mom talked about getting her financial information organized, and do you know what she's comfortable sharing?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**2.** Do you know each source of Mom's income: Social Security, a pension, anything else that comes in regularly?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**3.** Do you know where Mom has accounts: checking, savings, CDs, and any investment or retirement accounts?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**4.** Do you know which insurance she has: life insurance, an annuity, long-term care insurance, health coverage?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**5.** Do you know what property she owns: her home, any other real estate, vehicles, a business interest?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**6.** Do you know what she owes, and what her regular monthly expenses are?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**7.** For each account and property, do you know whose name it's in?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**8.** Do you know who is named as beneficiary on her accounts and policies?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**9.** Could you find a recent statement for each of her accounts?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**10.** Do you know where her insurance policies and the deed to her home are kept?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**11.** Do you know where her recent tax returns are?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**12.** Is there one place where this paperwork is kept, and does someone besides Mom know where it is?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**13.** Have you written down the questions you'd want to ask a professional?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

**Answer the questions above and your page builds here.**

**WHAT YOU KNOW**

**WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR**

**QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY**

**What this doesn't do**

It counts what your family knows and can find, not what Mom has or what any of it means. A low count means there are things to look for, and most of them are a conversation with Mom or a look through a drawer away. Nothing here says whether she would qualify for anything, and nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

## Ready for the next step?

You can see which parts of Mom's financial picture you have and which you'd still have to look for. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

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